



Civic Meeting Report

09-24-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8dZc1Tn5n4Y
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Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee work session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education was called to order by Board President Mr. Williams.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Dr. Watford, Mr. Irvan, Mr. Lakes, and President Williams.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Heeter.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams (Board President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting featured extensive student and staff presentations celebrating the start of the school year, athletics, and recent milestones.

- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond standard procedural progression.)*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:57 Presentation: Muncie Central High School Updates & Recognitions

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Muncie Central High School administration, joined by student council representatives and Teacher of the Year Sarah Hoffman.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Celebrated Muncie Central's band winning their 10th Indiana State Fair Band Day Championship (and first undefeated track show season).
 - Highlighted the opening of the new athletic locker room and concession facility, as well as the newly launched Esports arena (funded via a Gear Up grant).
 - Noted a 40% reduction in out-of-school suspension (OSS) incidents compared to the prior year.
 - Highlighted new pathways including Early College, Ivy Tech/Ivy Academy partnerships, direct admission pathways to Ball State University for seniors with a 3.0+ GPA, and preschool tutoring jobs for high school students.
 - Student body president Jamar Clark and junior class president Amaya shared their extracurricular involvements, future career aspirations, and positive feedback regarding the early college program (while requesting flexibility on hallway passes).
 - Teacher Sarah Hoffman shared her experiences teaching dual-credit math and AP physics, noting significant growth in student enrollment and success in advanced coursework.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

00:46:53 Consent Agenda Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed routine consent items, including donations to the Panther Pantry at Southside Middle School and new staff introductions.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:47:53 Financial Report & Construction Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Doss (Chief Financial Officer).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Reported August state revenue of approximately \$3.956 million, staying on pace for roughly \$47 million in basic grant revenue (subject to final ADM reconciliation in

November).

- Payroll for the month was over \$2.8 million; total employee headcount stands at 614 (including 374 teachers, down 8 from May).
- Overall cash balance sits just over \$31 million at the end of August. Outstanding school loan is down to \$8.6 million.
- Core Construction will receive bids on September 25 for the \$6.1 million Muncie Fieldhouse HVAC and cooling renovation project. A temporary boiler will be installed at the end of October to cover the winter basketball season. Bonds will be sold competitively on October 21 following an S&P ratings call on October 3.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:55:09 Policy Revisions

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Legal Counsel.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed required annual and statutory policy updates, including legal settlement guidelines, medical needs at school, purchasing procedures and capital assets (keeping the capitalization threshold at \$10,000 while noting state statutory bid adjustments), and audio/video recording guidelines on school property.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment period was conducted; floor discussion was restricted to board members, administrators, teachers, and student presenters.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds provided updates on the recent homecoming parade, football win against Anderson, upcoming parent-teacher conferences, early release days, and the upcoming fall break.
 - The board and administration briefly discussed the recent wave of social media threats affecting schools across the state, praising the Muncie Police Department and internal school security for their swift response and collaborative protective measures.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by voice vote at approximately 1 hour in duration (01:02:59).
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